



**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

STATE 2021

FINAL

Presentation Points _____ (140 points)

Specification Points _____ (20 points)

TOTAL POINTS _____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

Description

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

State Final Key Scenario

Chris was recently hired as a social media strategist for a local marketing agency. As a social media strategist, Chris often will give presentations, conduct meetings, and initiate/respond to a variety of correspondence with colleagues from all levels of the organization. Although the workplace culture is friendly and relaxed, his peers have noted that Chris oftentimes refers to his superiors and clients by their first names. He normally arrives at least five minutes late and is known to reply to text messages and check both personal and company social media sites during company meetings. With his friendly and outgoing attitude, Chris is both well received and respected by his colleagues and supervisors alike. He is in line for a promotion and has scheduled a meeting with his supervisor to discuss his chances.

- How does Chris influence the other employees in the workplace?
- Is Chris's casual behavior appropriate for all interactions?
- How does Chris's version of professionalism reflect upon the company image?
- If you were Chris's supervisor, what suggestions would you have to improve his chances of promotion using the *Ethics and Professional Resources Manual*?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Good business ethics requires that ethical behavior be practiced both internally as well as outside of the business.
- Paying respect to co-workers, oneself and clients, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional.
- Professionalism plays an important role in how a person is perceived by his/her employer, his/her co-workers and casual contacts.
- The way that a person is first perceived in a meeting, whether casual or professional, can determine the final outcome of the engagement.
- Strong leaders exhibit appropriate professional communication skills.
- Individuals that arrive consistently late for work or appointments disrespect not only their peers, but their employers as well.
- Both you and your organization's reputation can be reinforced by utilizing good manners and professionalism.

Possible Judge Questions

- If you discovered your boss did not have the same ethical standards you have, what would you do?
- Describe a time when you had to make an ethical decision.